

WHERE ARE AUSTRALIA'S NEXT COMMUNITY CRICKETERS?

A public-data decision-support prototype for community cricket participation growth

Executive Brief | Md Musa | August 2026

BUSINESS QUESTION If Australian Cricket has limited acquisition resources, which communities deserve deeper investigation first - and why?

Decision takeaway: screen demographic opportunity first, diagnose cricket readiness second, then choose the intervention.

Full portfolio: <https://github.com/YOUR-USERNAME/community-cricket-opportunity>

365

Eligible LGAs

17

Very High

18

Robust Top-20

94.6%

Top-20 growth in 4 major systems

MODEL V1

Equal-weighted percentile pillars: **Market Size**, **Youth Concentration**, and **Growth Momentum** (absolute + percentage five-year junior growth).

TOP 5 OPPORTUNITY POTENTIAL

Rank	LGA	Score
1	Wyndham, VIC	99.27
2	Melton, VIC	98.22
3	Blacktown, NSW	97.21
4	Ipswich, QLD	96.58
5	Camden, NSW	96.39

STRONGEST FINDINGS

- Market size alone is misleading: total population and junior market size are almost the same signal (Spearman ≈ 0.99).
- Junior growth adds distinct information (overall vs junior growth ≈ 0.57), supporting a separate Growth Momentum pillar.
- Four major growth systems - outer Melbourne, western/south-west Sydney, South East Queensland and Perth - account for 94.6% of the Top-20 absolute junior-population increase.

WHAT CRICKET AUSTRALIA SHOULD DO

1. Build Opportunity $\times$ Readiness prioritisation

Use Model V1 to choose where to investigate, then add registrations, club/program supply, facilities and capacity before allocating resources.

2. Plan by growth corridor, not only LGA

Coordinate adjacent high-growth areas as shared participation systems, especially across the four major growth corridors.

3. Separate acquisition, conversion, retention and capacity

Track first-time registrations, return rates, Blast-to-club conversion, waitlists and facility utilisation - not just total participation.

CASE-STUDY SIGNALS

Wyndham: capacity audit + targeted acquisition

Blacktown: potential capacity-constrained priority

Ipswich: activate around new capacity

Armadale: validate demand before scaling

Maitland: regional growth activation

IMPORTANT LIMITATION

Model V1 is a relative demographic screening tool. It does not measure actual cricket demand, participation penetration, future registrations, or national Cricket System Readiness.